

WHAT IS MYSCRUMBUDGET™?

MyScrumBudget™ is a browser-based budget forecasting tool for Scrum project managers. It replaces the original GPL-licensed Excel spreadsheet with a modern, interactive web app. Enter team members, monthly allocation percentages, and a baseline budget — the app calculates labor costs, forecast metrics (ETC, EAC, variance, burn rate, NPV), and visualizes spending over time with SVG charts.

ETC	Estimate to Complete — sum of all forecasted future labor costs based on current allocations. Derived from team member rates, available workdays per month, allocation percentages, and any productivity windows. Pre-cutoff months are excluded when an Actuals Through Date is set.
EAC	Estimate at Completion — Actual Cost already spent + ETC. The total expected project spend at the current forecast. Color-coded with a traffic-light status indicator.
Variance	EAC – Baseline Budget. Positive = over budget (red ▲); negative = under budget. Variance % = variance / baseline. Default thresholds: Amber > 5%, Red > 15%, Violet < –20% (materially under budget).
Budget Ratio	Baseline ÷ EAC. Greater than 1.0 = under budget (green ▲); less than 1.0 = over budget (red ▼). This is NOT an EVM CPI — MyScrumBudget does not track earned value.
Weekly Burn Rate	ETC ÷ weeks in the active forecast period. Tells you the average weekly spending rate to complete remaining work.
NPV	Net Present Value of forecasted monthly cash flows. Uses the annual discount rate from Settings, converted to monthly (annual ÷ 12) for standard financial semantics.
Charter Budget	An uncertainty-adjusted budget: the live ETC plus a parametric contingency computed at a chosen confidence percentile. A five-question risk profile drives a coefficient of variation; you pick a percentile (P60–P95) and a distribution. A planning heuristic, not a guarantee. See the Charter Budget section.

■ Available hours are calculated from actual weekdays (Mon–Fri) in each month × 8 hours/day. Partial first and last months are clipped to the active reforecast's start/end dates for accurate cost calculation.

STEP-BY-STEP WORKFLOW

#	Page / Area	What to do
1	Settings	Configure global Labor Rates (role → hourly rate), Holidays (non-work days subtracted from workday counts), annual Discount Rate for NPV, and Dashboard Thresholds (Amber, Red, and Violet variance % cutoffs). Bulk-load USA federal holidays by year.
2	Team Pool	Add team members to the global pool (name + role). Pool members can be assigned to any project. Each member's role links to a labor rate in Settings. Sort by name or role. Archive members who are no longer active — they are removed from the + Add member picker but preserved in all historical reforecasts.
3	New Project	Click + New Project on the Dashboard. Enter a project name, start date, end date, and optional baseline budget. The end date auto-suggests the next business day. These dates define the baseline reforecast's window ; each reforecast can later carry its own independent start/end dates.

4	Assign Members	Open the project. In the Allocation Grid, click + Add member to assign pool members to the active reforecast . Team assignments belong to the active reforecast — other reforecasts retain their own independent rosters. The same pool member can be added multiple times. Removing a member affects only the active reforecast; sibling reforecasts are not changed.
5	Enter Allocations	Fill in monthly allocation percentages for each team member in the spreadsheet-like grid. Enter 0–100 per cell (100 = full-time). Use keyboard navigation, drag-to-fill, or multi-cell selection for fast data entry.
6	Review Metrics	The Project Summary bar shows Baseline Budget, Actual Cost, ETC, and EAC with traffic-light status (Green / Amber / Red / Violet for under-budget). The Forecast Metrics panel shows all eight metrics. The stacked bar chart shows actual (teal) + forecast (blue) per month; the cumulative chart shows a solid teal segment through actuals and a dashed blue segment for the forecast trajectory. Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Shift+Z (or the toolbar Undo/Redo buttons) step back or forward through project changes — up to 50 steps, session-only.
7	Reforecast	Click + New Reforecast to create a named snapshot. Optionally copy from an existing reforecast (the dropdown defaults to the newest) — copying clones the team roster and allocations together. Switch between reforecasts via the dropdown. Each reforecast has its own team roster , allocations, productivity windows, Actual Cost, Baseline Budget, Actuals Through Date, optional Notes, and independent start/end dates . A blank new reforecast inherits the baseline reforecast's window; a copy inherits the source's dates. Sibling reforecasts are never affected when you edit the active reforecast's window.
8	Charter Budget	Optionally open the Charter Budget panel (below the allocation grid) to turn the deterministic ETC into an uncertainty-adjusted charter budget. Answer five risk questions, pick a confidence percentile and distribution, and apply the result as the active reforecast's baseline budget.

■ Enter the cumulative cost already spent in the **Actual Cost** field (click the card to edit inline). $EAC = \text{Actual Cost} + ETC$, so keeping this field current gives you the most accurate forecast. When Actuals Through Date is set, the Historical Cost Breakdown table (below the charts) lets you distribute that total across individual months.

ALLOCATION GRID — EDITING & NAVIGATION

Cell editing	Click or double-click a cell to edit. Type a number (0–100) and press Enter to save and move down, Tab to move right, or Escape to cancel. Typing a digit while a cell is selected starts editing immediately.
Keyboard navigation	Arrow keys move between cells. Tab / Shift+Tab move right / left. Enter saves and moves down. Delete clears selected cells. Press Ctrl+? anywhere to open the shortcuts reference.
Range selection	Click and drag to select a range. Shift+Click to extend a selection. Delete clears all selected cells. A selected range is highlighted — useful for bulk-clearing a period.
Drag-to-fill	Select one or more cells, then drag the fill handle (small square at the bottom-right of the selection) across adjacent cells to copy the value. Useful for repeating a constant allocation across months.
Row reorder	Drag the row handle (six-dot grip) on a member row to reorder team members in the grid. Drag reorder resets any active sort. Use the column header sort to re-sort by name or role-then-name.
Summary rows	Below the member rows: Total Hours and Total Cost per month (affected by productivity windows). These read-only rows update instantly as allocations change.
Resource Plan (Excel)	The collapsible section below the allocation grid supports round-tripping the active reforecast's allocations as a .xlsx file. Export Resource Plan produces a spreadsheet with Name, Role, and one column per project month; allocation cells are pale yellow (the edit zone). Import Resource Plan validates file origin and project ID, then merges changes: new pool members are added (red role if unrecognized), absent members removed from the active reforecast, archived pool members matching an imported name are automatically reactivated (W5 toast). Hard errors block import; soft warnings surface as toasts after success. Only the active reforecast is affected.

Note: Allocations are stored as entered — productivity windows are a calculation overlay only. Changing or removing a productivity window never modifies your saved allocation data.

REFORECASTS & PRODUCTIVITY WINDOWS

Reforecast	A named snapshot of the team roster , allocations, productivity windows, actual cost, and baseline budget for a project. Every project starts with one reforecast. Each reforecast carries its own independent start and end dates — the allocation grid, calc engine, and charts all read from the active reforecast's window. Editing one reforecast's dates never affects siblings, enabling true what-if timeline comparisons. Create new reforecasts to model scenarios or track budget changes over time (e.g., 'Original', 'Q2 Reforecast', 'Post-Scope-Change').
Create	Click + New Reforecast in the toolbar. Enter a name (up to 50 characters). Optionally copy from any existing reforecast — the default is the most recent. Copying clones the team roster, allocations, and start/end dates together, plus the Actual Cost, historical costs, and Actuals Through Date (assignment IDs are preserved so allocation linkage is maintained). A blank new reforecast inherits the baseline reforecast's start/end window. If a date change trims allocations, removes historical-cost entries, or clamps dates, a confirmation dialog surfaces the exact adjustments with <i>from</i> → <i>to</i> values before applying. Choose 'Start fresh' for a blank slate with no inherited allocations.
Actuals Through Date	Optional per-reforecast field (date picker in the toolbar). Sets a cutoff date telling the calc engine where actuals end. Pre-cutoff months are automatically zeroed (fully covered by actuals); the cutoff month is prorated (only workdays after the cutoff date contribute to ETC); post-cutoff months are unchanged. All derived metrics (EAC, variance, burn rate, charts) reflect the adjustment. Constrained to the reforecast's own start/end window. Leave blank for no cutoff.
Notes	Optional free-text narrative per reforecast (max 2,000 characters). Record why a reforecast was created — scope changes, team shifts, executive direction, etc. Click the note icon below the toolbar to expand the collapsible panel. When a reforecast has content, the icon fills and a dot indicator appears. Notes persist independently per reforecast and round-trip through JSON export/import.
Switch / Rename	Select a reforecast from the dropdown to view and edit its allocations and metrics. The dropdown is sorted newest-first by Reforecast Date (then by creation date as a tiebreaker). To rename the active reforecast, click the pencil icon next to the dropdown — it swaps in a text input in place (same toolbar slot, no layout shift). Press Enter or blur to commit; Escape to cancel. Empty names are rejected; names are trimmed and clamped to 50 characters.
Delete	Click the trash icon at the far-right edge of the toolbar to remove the active reforecast. A confirmation dialog is shown before deletion proceeds. The last remaining reforecast cannot be deleted.
Productivity window	Define a date range + capacity factor (0–100%). A factor of 50% means the team delivers half their normal velocity during that period. Add via the collapsible panel below the grid. Productivity windows that fall fully outside the active reforecast's start/end window receive a warning indicator (!) with a tooltip; they are not auto-deleted — edit them back into range without delete-and-recreate.
Day-weighted blending	When a productivity window partially overlaps a month, the factor is day-weighted. A one-week 0% window in a 30-day month reduces that month's effective factor to ~77%, not 0%. Overlapping windows take the minimum factor for each day.

FORECAST METRICS & CHARTS

Project Summary bar	Always visible at the top of a project. Shows Start / Finish dates (reflects the active reforecast's window — switching reforecasts updates the displayed dates immediately), Baseline Budget (click to edit inline), Actual Cost (click to edit inline), ETC, and EAC. EAC is color-coded with a traffic-light indicator (On Track / At Risk / Over Budget / Under Budget). To change the active reforecast's start/end dates, click Edit Project — a confirmation dialog appears if the change would trim allocations or clamp dates; sibling reforecasts are not affected. Hover the Actual Cost, ETC, or EAC tile for a tooltip showing the full EVM term (<i>Actual Cost (AC)</i> , <i>Estimate to Complete (ETC)</i> , <i>Estimate at Completion (EAC)</i>). When a charter budget is set on the active reforecast, a compact badge under the Baseline tile shows the percentile and distribution (e.g. <i>P80 · Normal</i>), an optional <i>+N% bias</i> tag, and a <i>stale</i> flag if the ETC has since drifted; a Set / Edit link opens the panel.
Forecast Metrics panel	Eight metric cards: ETC, EAC, Variance (\$), Variance %, Budget Ratio, Weekly Burn Rate, NPV, and Total Hours. Variance and Ratio show directional indicators (▲ over budget, ▼ under). The EAC card carries the same traffic-light color as the Project Summary bar (including Violet for materially under-budget projects).
Monthly Cost bar chart	Stacked bar chart showing labor cost per month. The actual portion (teal) sits below the forecast portion (blue). In cutoff months, a two-segment stack visualizes the actual/forecast split explicitly; tooltips break down <i>Actual / Forecast / Total</i> for blended bars. Updates in real time as allocations or productivity windows change. The copy icon in the panel header copies the chart panel to your clipboard as a PNG (disabled in Firefox).
Cumulative Cost line chart	Plots the EAC trajectory month by month against the Baseline Budget (horizontal reference line). The line is solid teal through any month containing actuals (including the blended cutoff month) and switches to dashed blue for the pure forecast trajectory beyond the cutoff. Hover for per-month cumulative totals. Click the copy icon in the panel header to copy the chart as a PNG to your clipboard (disabled in Firefox).
Historical Cost Breakdown	Collapsible table below the cost charts (visible when Actuals Through Date is set). One editable row per month from project start through the cutoff. Enter how actual costs were distributed across periods; the cutoff-month row is read-only and auto-derives as <i>Actual Cost – sum of earlier-month entries</i> , keeping the column sum exactly equal to Actual Cost. Over-allocation attempts are clamped with a toast.
Cost by Period table	Below the charts: a year-by-year breakdown of forecasted hours and cost. Shows the annual subtotals for quick budget period review.
Print report	Click the printer icon (beside Edit on the project detail page) to open the browser's native print dialog. A compact two-page report renders automatically: page 1 is an executive summary (header, RAG status banner, project summary, active reforecast, and all forecast metrics as dense label/value tables); page 2 holds the Monthly Cost chart, Cumulative Cost chart, and Cost by Period table. Charts always print in light mode regardless of your current color scheme. Choose Save as PDF in the print dialog (available on macOS, Windows, and Chrome OS) to export a PDF snapshot. When 'Headers and footers' is enabled, the browser header shows the project name and today's date.
Traffic-light thresholds	Configurable in Settings → Dashboard Thresholds. Four status bands: Violet when variance % is more than <i>violetPercent% below</i> budget (default 20% — a project tracking materially under budget may need a formal change request to sponsors); Green (on track, within thresholds); Amber when variance % > <i>amberPercent</i> (default 5%); Red when variance % > <i>redPercent</i> (default 15%). Boundaries are exclusive — e.g., –20.0% stays Green; –20.1% is Violet. An inline warning appears in Settings if the Violet threshold is set to 0% (any under-budget project would trigger Violet).

CHARTER BUDGET

The **Charter Budget** panel (below the allocation grid) turns the deterministic ETC point estimate into an uncertainty-adjusted budget at a chosen confidence percentile. The live ETC pre-populates as the cost basis; a five-question risk profile derives a coefficient of variation (CV), and the model computes a charter budget at your selected percentile and distribution. It is a transparent planning heuristic — every contingency dollar traces to a risk-profile selection — **not a guarantee**.

Risk profile (5 questions)	Five dropdowns: Project type (COTS/vendor → AI/ML, setting the base CV), Requirements clarity , Team experience , Org-change impact , and Integration complexity . The last four apply favorable / neutral / unfavorable deltas to the base CV. A live CV breakdown table shows each contribution (green = favorable, amber = unfavorable) and the applied CV.
Distribution & percentile	Choose a distribution — Normal (default), Lognormal , or Beta-PERT — and a target confidence percentile from P60 to P95 . A distribution-specific mini chart and results cards (applied CV, σ , P50 median, charter budget) update reactively as you change inputs.
CV governance	The composite CV is clamped to a floor of 8% and a ceiling of 50% . The ceiling is surfaced as a governance signal that scope may be too unstable to charter. A typed manual CV override (8–50%) bypasses the ceiling as a deliberate user assertion; the floor still binds.
Optimism-bias uplift	Optional, opt-in (default 0). A direct-percentage adjustment that raises the cost basis <i>before</i> contingency, shown as a distinct labeled line so the sponsor sees the expected-overrun correction and the risk contingency separately.
Schedule-source nudge	A checkbox flagging that the ETC came from a P80+ schedule forecast (e.g., SPERT® Forecaster). When set, the panel recommends targeting P60 to avoid stacking P80 cost on a P80 schedule, and warns if uplift is also active.
Apply & badge	Apply as baseline budget writes the charter amount (rounded to the nearest whole dollar) to the active reforecast's baseline budget. A compact badge on the Baseline tile then shows $P\{n\} \cdot \{Distribution\}$ with optional <i>+N% bias</i> and <i>stale</i> variants. The charter is a point-in-time artifact stored on the active reforecast; if the live ETC later drifts, the badge flags it stale rather than auto-recomputing.
■ The charter is stored per reforecast (cleared on clone — a copy starts uncharted) and round-trips through JSON export/import. For the full statistical model — CV calibration, the three distributions, research basis, and P80-schedule integration — see the separate Charter Budget Reference Guide.	

SETTINGS, TEAM POOL & DATA

Labor Rates (Settings)	Define roles and hourly rates — e.g., 'Scrum Master' at \$120/hr. Rates are global: updating a rate immediately affects all projects that use that role. Roles deleted from Settings will produce \$0 cost for any assigned members.
Holidays (Settings)	Add date-ranged non-work days that are excluded from all workday calculations. Single-day or multi-day ranges both supported. Bulk-load USA federal holidays for 2026, 2027, or 2028.
Annual Discount Rate	(Settings) Used for NPV calculation. Entered as a percentage (e.g., 8.0). Stored as a decimal and divided by 12 monthly for standard financial NPV semantics.
Dashboard Thresholds	(Settings) Configure the four traffic-light bands: Amber (% over budget, default 5), Red (% over budget, default 15), and Violet (% under budget, default 20). An inline warning appears if Violet is set to 0%. Thresholds take effect immediately across all dashboard project tiles.
Team Pool (Sidebar)	Manage the global member roster. Add members with name and role; edit, delete, or archive . Deletion is blocked if the member is referenced in any reforecast — an inline Archive instead button appears as a non-destructive alternative. Archived members are excluded from the + Add member picker but still render in any reforecast that references them (costs, allocations, and charts preserved). A Show archived (N) toggle reveals muted rows with an Unarchive action. Adding a new member whose name matches an archived one opens a dialog: Unarchive , Add as new , or Cancel .
Export	(Settings → Export) Downloads all projects, team pool, and settings as a timestamped JSON backup file. Export regularly — clearing browser data permanently deletes all stored information.
Import (Dashboard)	Click Import JSON on the Dashboard to restore from a backup. Instead of an all-or-nothing replace, it shows a per-project preview with conflict detection: each project gets Add / Skip / Replace (ID and name conflicts are labeled with the colliding project's name), Settings get Keep / Replace , and the Team Pool gets Keep / Merge / Replace (defaults to Merge). Every conflict starts as Skip — Replace is always explicit, so the import never silently overwrites. Migrations run automatically; nothing is written until you Apply.
Cloud storage (optional)	Click the auth chip (top-right of any page) to open the Cloud Storage modal, or navigate to Settings → Cloud Storage. Sign in with Google or Microsoft to sync via Firebase across devices and share with collaborators (owner, editor, viewer roles). The modal lets you toggle Local/Cloud mode and adjust preferences. Data never leaves your device unless you opt in.
Dashboard	Home page showing all projects as tiles. Each tile displays the project name, date range, EAC, and traffic-light status — including Violet for projects tracking materially under budget. Drag tiles to reorder; click to open a project. An empty Dashboard shows a 3-step Getting Started guide with green checkmarks as each step is completed.
Dark mode	Click the light/dark/system toggle in the sidebar footer to switch color modes. System follows your OS preference. The setting persists across sessions.
Keyboard shortcuts	Press Ctrl+? from any page to open the shortcuts reference. Allocation Grid: Arrow keys (navigate), Tab/Shift+Tab (right/left), Enter (save + move down), Delete (clear cell), digit key (start editing immediately). Project detail page: Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Shift+Z (Cmd on Mac) for Undo / Redo — up to 50 steps, session-only. Toolbar Undo/Redo buttons also available.

Note: All data is stored in your browser's localStorage by default — it never leaves your device unless you opt in to Cloud Storage. Clearing browser cache or site data permanently deletes all local projects and settings. Export backups regularly.